Response Checklist for Suspicious Mail and Unknown Powders or Substances

June 2009

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

UNITED STATES POSTAL INSPECTION SERVICE

Response Checklist

1. Leave the mail item or substance where it was found. Do not disturb. Do not try to clean up the substance.

2. Clear people from the immediate area and keep others away.

3. Instruct anyone who may have had contact with the item or substance to wash hands and other exposed skin with soap and water. Direct them to wait in a designated area for further instructions.

4. Cordon off the immediate area.

5. Shut down all equipment in the immediate area.

6. Shut down all heating, ventilation, and air conditioning systems.

7. **Without disturbing the mail item or substance, document:**

   Location of the mail item or substance:

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

   _____

Description of the substance:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Description of the mail item:
(markings, labels, declarations, postage)

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Name and address of the addressee on the mail item:

_____

_____

_____

Name and address of the mailer on the mail item:

_____

_____

_____

8. Call the Postal Inspection Service. Tell them what you know about the mail item or substance. They will conduct a threat assessment.

Call your local Postal Inspection Service office or the 24-hour, toll-free number:

877-876-2455 (option 2)

9. Take protective actions based on your local emergency action plan.

10. Call your district Homeland Security Coordinator to report this incident.

11. Communicate immediately with employees, local unions, and management associations. Convey only the facts – avoid speculation!

If there is evidence of an emergency, such as smoke, fumes, vapors, or employees exhibiting medical symptoms, call 911, then your local Postal Inspection Service office and:

- **Activate your local emergency plan.**
- **Evacuate the area.**

12. List the names of each person in the immediate area of the mail item or substance:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

13. Additional comments:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

14. Additional information:

_____
Facility

_____
Date

_____
Signature

http://blue.usps.gov/nationalpreparedness

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